Knowledge organiser (TRACK) — Planning the piece: four composition choices

Pathway: TRACK · Week 3 Part 1 · Big question: How do four deliberate choices — focal point, palette, background pattern, and medium — shape an identity piece?

Core studio focus

Family: Identity and studio log

Big question: How do four deliberate choices — focal point, palette, background pattern, and medium — shape an identity piece?

• Test two thumbnail compositions comparing central vs off-centre focal placement.

• Select a purposeful three-colour palette (warm/cool contrast or harmonious tones).

• Produce an annotated A4 composition plan ready for next week's final build.

Essential vocabulary

• composition: How shapes, lines, and colours are arranged inside the frame.

• focal point: The main area of high contrast that pulls the viewer's eye first.

• thumbnail: A small rapid sketch used to test layout ideas before working big.

• complementary: Colours opposite each other on the colour wheel that create bold contrast.

• balance: Arranging visual weight so the picture feels stable and purposeful.

Three-step studio method

Step 1: Draw two contrasting thumbnails: I sketch Thumbnail A (centred motif with radiating pattern) and Thumbnail B (off-centre motif with diagonal grid).

Step 2: Swatch a three-colour palette: I test deep indigo, warm ochre amber, and crisp white in my swatch boxes to guarantee dark-to-light contrast.

Step 3: Scale up the winning plan with annotations: I draw my chosen layout in the main frame and add four pointer notes naming focal point, pattern, palette, and medium.